Science and social studies report card comments by grade

Find the student's grade band and pick two or three skills. For each, use a **strength** or **on track** line, then at most one **next step** and one thing to try **at home**. Swap [Name] and "their" for the student's name and pronoun, and check each line against your own grade-level standards and this term's units.

Science: Grades K–2

Observing and asking questions

- **STRENGTH** [Name] notices small details when observing and describes them clearly.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] asks thoughtful questions about the world around them.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] is learning to look closely and describe what they see.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] asks questions about what they see and is beginning to say what might happen.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is looking closely and saying what they notice, using their senses, which we're practicing with magnifying glasses and nature walks.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could go on a short nature walk and ask [Name] what they notice.

Simple tests and investigations

- **STRENGTH** [Name] carries out simple tests carefully and says what happened.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] follows the steps of a simple test and suggests what to try next.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] joins in with simple tests and is beginning to predict what will happen.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] carries out simple tests with help and talks about what happened.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is making a prediction before a test and checking it afterwards, which we're practicing with hands-on activities and "what do you think will happen?" questions.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could try a simple test together, such as which toy cars roll furthest down a ramp.

Measuring and recording results

- **STRENGTH** [Name] records what they see carefully in pictures, tally marks and simple tables.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] measures carefully with simple equipment and records results neatly.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] records results in pictures and is beginning to use simple tables.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] is learning to use simple equipment such as rulers and timers.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is recording what they see in a simple table, which we're practicing with picture tables and class charts.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could measure a plant or a shadow each day for a week and keep a simple chart.

Explaining what happened

- **STRENGTH** [Name] explains what happened in a test and why they think it happened.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] uses what they see to answer questions about the world around them.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] says what happened in a test and is beginning to say why.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] is learning to use what they see to answer simple questions.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is saying what happened and why they think it happened, which we're practicing with talk partners and sentence starters.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could ask "why do you think that happened?" when something changes, such as a puddle drying up.

Science vocabulary

- **STRENGTH** [Name] uses new science words correctly, such as "melt", "habitat" and "material".
- **STRENGTH** [Name] remembers the science words we learn and uses them in conversation.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] is learning new science words and is beginning to use them.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] uses some science words and is building their vocabulary each topic.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is using new science words when talking about what they see, which we're practicing with word mats and picture cards.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could ask [Name] to teach you a new science word from this week.

Understanding of our topics

- **STRENGTH** [Name] has a secure understanding of our topics and remembers key ideas well.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] explains the main ideas from our topics clearly and links them together.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] understands the main ideas from our topics and is building on them.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] remembers key facts from our topics and is getting better at explaining them.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is remembering key ideas from earlier topics and linking them to new ones, which we're practicing with short quizzes and topic recaps.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could ask [Name] to tell you three things they learned in science this week.

Practical work and safety

- **STRENGTH** [Name] handles equipment carefully and follows safety instructions closely.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] works sensibly and safely in practical lessons and helps others do the same.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] follows safety instructions and is becoming more confident with equipment.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] works carefully in practical lessons and is learning to use new equipment.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is following each step of a practical method carefully, which we're practicing with step-by-step method cards.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could follow a recipe together, step by step, and talk about why the order matters.

Science: Grades 3–5

Observing and asking questions

- **STRENGTH** [Name] makes careful observations and asks questions that can be tested.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] notices patterns and asks good questions about why they happen.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] makes observations and is learning to turn their questions into ones we can test.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] notices changes and is getting better at describing them in detail.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is turning a question into one we can test, which we're practicing with question walls and short investigations.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could ask "I wonder why...?" together about something you see, such as ice melting or bread going moldy.

Planning fair tests

- **STRENGTH** [Name] plans fair tests, changing one thing and keeping everything else the same.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] sets up investigations carefully and explains why each step matters.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] understands what makes a test fair and is learning to plan one on their own.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] follows investigation steps carefully and is beginning to plan their own.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is planning a fair test, changing just one thing at a time, which we're practicing with planning boards and practical lessons.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could try a kitchen test together, such as which paper towel soaks up the most water, changing only the brand.

Measuring and recording results

- **STRENGTH** [Name] takes accurate measurements and records results clearly in tables.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] records results carefully and chooses a sensible way to present them.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] measures carefully and is learning to record results in a table with units.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] takes measurements and is getting more accurate with scales and units.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is recording results in a clear table, with units, which we're practicing with ready-made tables we fill in together.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could measure something that changes, such as a plant or the temperature, each day for a week and record it in a table.

Drawing conclusions

- **STRENGTH** [Name] draws sensible conclusions from results and explains them clearly.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] uses results to answer the question and suggests what to test next.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] says what the results show and is learning to explain why.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] draws simple conclusions and is beginning to link them to the question.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is using results to explain the answer, not just saying what happened, which we're practicing with "I found that... because..." sentence starters.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could ask "how do you know?" when [Name] tells you a science fact.

Diagrams and models

- **STRENGTH** [Name] draws clear, labeled diagrams and uses them to explain ideas.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] uses models and diagrams to explain how things work.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] draws labeled diagrams and is learning to use them to explain ideas.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] is getting more confident using models to explain how things work.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is using labeled diagrams to explain how something works, which we're practicing with diagram templates and modeling activities.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could ask [Name] to draw and label something you're both looking at, such as a plant or a bike.

Science vocabulary

- **STRENGTH** [Name] uses scientific vocabulary accurately in speaking and writing.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] learns new science words quickly and uses them correctly.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] uses key science words and is learning to use them precisely in writing.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] is building their science vocabulary and uses it more often in explanations.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is using science words accurately in written explanations, which we're practicing with topic word mats.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could ask [Name] to teach you three science words from our topic and what they mean.

Understanding of our topics

- **STRENGTH** [Name] has a secure understanding of our topics and remembers key ideas well.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] explains the main ideas from our topics clearly and links them together.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] understands the main ideas from our topics and is building on them.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] remembers key facts from our topics and is getting better at explaining them.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is remembering key ideas from earlier topics and linking them to new ones, which we're practicing with short quizzes and topic recaps.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could ask [Name] to tell you three things they learned in science this week.

Science: Grades 6–8

Observing and asking questions

- **STRENGTH** [Name] asks precise questions that can be investigated and explains why they matter.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] makes careful, detailed observations and uses them to raise new questions.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] asks good questions and is learning to make them precise enough to test.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] makes observations and is getting more detailed in what they record.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is writing precise questions that an investigation can answer, which we're practicing with investigation planning sheets.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could watch a short science video together and ask [Name] what question they would want to test next.

Planning investigations

- **STRENGTH** [Name] plans investigations independently, choosing what to change, measure and keep the same.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] designs clear, careful investigations and explains how they make the results reliable.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] plans investigations with some support and is learning to control the things that stay the same.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] follows a method carefully and is learning to plan their own.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is planning an investigation on their own, including what to keep the same, which we're practicing with planning templates and practical lessons.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could plan a small test at home together, such as which drink cools fastest, and talk about how to make it fair.

Measuring and recording results

- **STRENGTH** [Name] takes accurate, repeated measurements and records them clearly with units.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] records data carefully and spots results that don't fit the pattern.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] records data accurately and is learning when to repeat measurements.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] takes careful measurements and is getting more consistent about units.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is repeating measurements and spotting results that don't fit, which we're practicing with results tables and practical lessons.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could time something a few times, such as how long ice takes to melt, and talk about why the results differ.

Explaining with evidence

- **STRENGTH** [Name] writes clear conclusions that use data as evidence and explain the science behind them.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] explains results using evidence and scientific ideas, and spots the limits of the data.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] states what the data shows and is learning to explain it using scientific ideas.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] writes conclusions and is learning to back each claim with evidence.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is backing up each conclusion with evidence from the data, which we're practicing with a three-part conclusion frame: what I found, my evidence, the science behind it.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could ask [Name] to explain a news story about science and what the evidence was.

Practical work and safety

- **STRENGTH** [Name] handles equipment carefully and follows safety instructions closely.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] works sensibly and safely in practical lessons and helps others do the same.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] follows safety instructions and is becoming more confident with equipment.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] works carefully in practical lessons and is learning to use new equipment.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is following each step of a practical method carefully, which we're practicing with step-by-step method cards.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could follow a recipe together, step by step, and talk about why the order matters.

Writing up investigations

- **STRENGTH** [Name] writes up investigations clearly, with a method, results and conclusion.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] writes clear, well-organized accounts of investigations.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] writes up investigations and is learning to include each section.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] is getting better at writing a clear method that someone else could follow.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is writing a method clear enough for someone else to follow, which we're practicing with writing frames and model examples.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could ask [Name] to explain how to do an everyday task step by step, as if writing instructions.

Diagrams and models

- **STRENGTH** [Name] draws clear, labeled diagrams and uses them to explain ideas.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] uses models and diagrams to explain how things work.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] draws labeled diagrams and is learning to use them to explain ideas.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] is getting more confident using models to explain how things work.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is using labeled diagrams to explain how something works, which we're practicing with diagram templates and modeling activities.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could ask [Name] to sketch a diagram explaining something at home, such as how a fridge keeps food cold.

Science vocabulary

- **STRENGTH** [Name] uses precise scientific vocabulary in explanations and written work.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] explains scientific terms clearly in their own words.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] uses key terms and is learning to use them precisely in longer answers.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] knows most key terms and is building confidence explaining them.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is using precise scientific terms in longer written answers, which we're practicing with key-term glossaries for each unit.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could ask [Name] to explain a key term from this unit in their own words.

Understanding of our topics

- **STRENGTH** [Name] has a secure understanding of our topics and remembers key ideas well.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] explains the main ideas from our topics clearly and links them together.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] understands the main ideas from our topics and is building on them.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] remembers key facts from our topics and is getting better at explaining them.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is remembering key ideas from earlier topics and linking them to new ones, which we're practicing with short quizzes and topic recaps.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could ask [Name] to tell you three things they learned in science this week.

Practical work and safety

- **STRENGTH** [Name] handles equipment carefully and follows safety instructions closely.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] works sensibly and safely in practical lessons and helps others do the same.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] follows safety instructions and is becoming more confident with equipment.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] works carefully in practical lessons and is learning to use new equipment.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is following each step of a practical method carefully, which we're practicing with step-by-step method cards.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could follow a recipe together, step by step, and talk about why the order matters.

Writing up investigations

- **STRENGTH** [Name] writes up investigations clearly, with a method, results and conclusion.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] writes clear, well-organized accounts of investigations.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] writes up investigations and is learning to include each section.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] is getting better at writing a clear method that someone else could follow.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is writing a method clear enough for someone else to follow, which we're practicing with writing frames and model examples.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could ask [Name] to explain how to do an everyday task step by step, as if writing instructions.

Social studies: Grades K–2

Understanding of our topics

- **STRENGTH** [Name] remembers what we have learned about people and places and talks about it with interest.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] shares what they know about our topics confidently.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] remembers key facts about our topics and is beginning to talk about them.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] is learning about our topics and enjoys sharing what they know.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is talking about what they know about our topics in full sentences, which we're practicing with picture prompts and class discussions.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could ask [Name] to tell you about one thing they learned this week.

Past and present

- **STRENGTH** [Name] talks about how life was different in the past and gives clear examples.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] orders events in time and uses words such as "before", "after" and "long ago".
- **ON TRACK** [Name] is learning to talk about how things were different in the past.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] orders familiar events and is beginning to use words about time.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is talking about how life was different in the past, which we're practicing with old photographs and objects.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could look at old family photos together and talk about what has changed.

Maps and places

- **STRENGTH** [Name] uses simple maps confidently and describes where places are.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] talks about places near and far and how they are different.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] is learning to use simple maps and to describe where things are.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] talks about our local area and is learning about places further away.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is using simple maps and direction words such as "near" and "far", which we're practicing with maps of our school and local area.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could draw a simple map of your home or your walk to school together.

Pictures, objects and sources

- **STRENGTH** [Name] looks closely at old pictures and objects and says what they tell us.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] asks good questions about photographs and objects from the past.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] is learning to look closely at pictures and objects and say what they show.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] is beginning to ask questions about old photographs and objects.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is saying what a picture or object tells us about the past, which we're practicing with "look, think, wonder" questions.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could look at an old object or photo together and ask [Name] what it tells you.

Asking questions

- **STRENGTH** [Name] asks interesting questions about people and places.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] is curious about the world and asks thoughtful questions.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] asks questions about our topics and is learning to find answers.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] is curious and is beginning to ask questions about the past and other places.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is asking "why" and "how" questions about our topics, which we're practicing with question boards.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could visit the library together and find a book about a place or time they are curious about.

Community and rules

- **STRENGTH** [Name] understands why we have rules and explains how people help in our community.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] talks thoughtfully about the jobs people do in our community.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] is learning about the people who help in our community and why we have rules.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] talks about our class rules and is learning why they matter.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is explaining why we have rules and who helps us in our community, which we're practicing with role play and class jobs.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could talk about the people who help in your community, such as librarians, nurses and bus drivers.

Discussion and presenting

- **STRENGTH** [Name] shares ideas confidently in class discussions and listens well to others.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] presents their work clearly and answers questions about it.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] joins in with class discussions and is building confidence sharing ideas.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] presents their work and is learning to speak to a group with confidence.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is sharing ideas in class discussions and building on what others say, which we're practicing with talk partners and sentence starters.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could ask [Name] at dinner what they think about something from our topic, and why.

Social studies: Grades 3–5

Understanding of our topics

- **STRENGTH** [Name] has a secure understanding of our topics and remembers key facts and ideas.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] explains the main ideas from our topics clearly and links them together.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] understands the main ideas from our topics and is building on them.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] remembers key facts and is getting better at explaining them.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is remembering key facts and ideas from earlier topics, which we're practicing with knowledge organizers and short quizzes.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could ask [Name] to teach you three facts from our topic.

Timelines and change over time

- **STRENGTH** [Name] places events confidently on a timeline and explains how things changed.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] understands how events connect over time and explains changes clearly.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] orders events on a timeline and is learning to explain what changed.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] is building a clear sense of when events happened.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is placing events on a timeline and explaining what changed, which we're practicing with class timelines.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could make a simple timeline of your family's or your town's history together.

Maps and places

- **STRENGTH** [Name] reads maps accurately, using compass directions, keys and grid references.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] locates countries and places confidently on a map or globe.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] uses maps and is learning to use compass directions and keys.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] locates some countries and places and is building their map knowledge.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is using compass directions, keys and grid references on a map, which we're practicing with map work and atlases.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could use a map or map app together to plan a short trip and talk about the directions.

Using sources

- **STRENGTH** [Name] finds useful information in sources and explains what they show.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] compares sources and notices when they disagree.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] finds information in sources and is learning to explain what they show.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] uses sources and is beginning to compare them.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is comparing two sources and explaining how they differ, which we're practicing with source question cards.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could compare two news reports or websites about the same event and talk about what's different.

Asking questions and research

- **STRENGTH** [Name] asks thoughtful questions and finds answers using books and websites.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] researches topics independently and picks out the most useful information.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] asks questions and is learning to find answers in books and on websites.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] researches with support and is learning to pick out the most useful information.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is finding the most useful information when researching, which we're practicing with research frames and guided library time.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could help [Name] research one question about our topic using a library book or a website.

Explaining causes and consequences

- **STRENGTH** [Name] explains why events happened and what they led to, with clear reasons.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] explains causes and effects clearly and links them together.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] is learning to explain why events happened and what they led to.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] gives reasons for events and is learning to link causes and effects.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is explaining why something happened and what it led to, which we're practicing with cause-and-effect organizers.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could ask "why do you think that happened?" about a story in the news or a family event.

Different points of view

- **STRENGTH** [Name] explains how different people might see the same event and why.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] listens to different points of view and responds respectfully, using evidence.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] is learning to explain how different people might see the same event.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] listens to different points of view and is learning to respond with evidence.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is explaining how people at the time might have seen events differently, which we're practicing with role play and structured discussions.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could talk about a news story together and ask [Name] how different people involved might feel about it.

Community and citizenship

- **STRENGTH** [Name] explains how communities work and how people can make a difference.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] understands how rules and laws are made and explains why they matter.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] is learning how communities and local government work.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] understands some rights and responsibilities and is learning to explain them.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is explaining how communities make decisions, which we're practicing with class votes and community projects.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could talk about a local decision together, such as a new park or road, and who decided it.

Discussion and presenting

- **STRENGTH** [Name] shares ideas confidently in class discussions and listens well to others.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] presents their work clearly and answers questions about it.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] joins in with class discussions and is building confidence sharing ideas.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] presents their work and is learning to speak to a group with confidence.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is sharing ideas in class discussions and building on what others say, which we're practicing with talk partners and sentence starters.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could ask [Name] at dinner what they think about something from our topic, and why.

Writing about our topics

- **STRENGTH** [Name] writes clear, well-organized pieces about our topics, using topic words.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] writes detailed explanations about our topics in their own words.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] writes about our topics and is learning to organize ideas into paragraphs.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] is getting better at explaining ideas in their own words.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is organizing their writing into clear paragraphs, which we're practicing with writing frames and model paragraphs.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could ask [Name] to tell you about our topic before writing, so the ideas are clear first.

Social studies: Grades 6–8

Understanding of our topics

- **STRENGTH** [Name] has a detailed understanding of the periods and places we have studied.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] links ideas across topics and explains how they connect.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] understands the main ideas from each unit and is building more detail.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] remembers key facts and is learning to link them across units.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is linking what we learn across units, which we're practicing with knowledge organizers and retrieval quizzes.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could ask [Name] to explain one thing they learned this week and why it matters.

Chronology and change over time

- **STRENGTH** [Name] has a secure sense of chronology and explains change and continuity clearly.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] explains how and why things changed over time, using precise dates and periods.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] places events in order and is learning to explain change and continuity.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] is building a clear sense of the periods we have studied.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is explaining what changed, what stayed the same and why, which we're practicing with timelines and comparison tables.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could talk with [Name] about how something has changed in your lifetime, such as phones or shops.

Maps, places and environments

- **STRENGTH** [Name] reads and interprets maps confidently, including scale and different types of map.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] explains how people and places affect each other, using clear examples.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] reads maps and is building confidence with scale and grid references.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] describes places and is learning to explain how people and environments affect each other.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is explaining how people and places affect each other, which we're practicing with maps, photographs and case studies.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could look at a news story about a place in the world and find it on a map together.

Using sources and evidence

- **STRENGTH** [Name] analyzes sources carefully, asking who made them and why.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] uses evidence from sources to support their points and judges how reliable they are.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] uses sources to find information and is learning to ask who made them and why.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] uses evidence and is learning to judge how reliable a source is.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is asking who made a source, when and why, before using it as evidence, which we're practicing with source analysis frames.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could when you see a claim online, ask [Name] who made it and why they might have made it.

Inquiry and research

- **STRENGTH** [Name] plans research carefully and chooses reliable sources.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] asks strong questions and follows them up with careful research.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] carries out research and is learning to choose reliable sources.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] asks good questions and is learning to plan research to answer them.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is choosing reliable sources and noting where information came from, which we're practicing with research planners and source checklists.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could ask [Name] how they know a website is trustworthy when doing homework.

Explaining causes and consequences

- **STRENGTH** [Name] explains why events happened and what they led to, with clear reasons.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] explains causes and effects clearly and links them together.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] is learning to explain why events happened and what they led to.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] gives reasons for events and is learning to link causes and effects.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is explaining why something happened and what it led to, which we're practicing with cause-and-effect organizers.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could talk about a news story together and ask [Name] what caused it and what might happen next.

Different points of view

- **STRENGTH** [Name] explains how different people might see the same event and why.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] listens to different points of view and responds respectfully, using evidence.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] is learning to explain how different people might see the same event.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] listens to different points of view and is learning to respond with evidence.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is explaining how people at the time might have seen events differently, which we're practicing with role play and structured discussions.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could talk about a news story together and ask [Name] how different people involved might feel about it.

Government and citizenship

- **STRENGTH** [Name] explains how government works and how citizens can take part.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] explains rights and responsibilities clearly, using examples.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] is learning how government works and how decisions are made.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] understands key rights and responsibilities and is building on them.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is explaining how decisions are made and how citizens can have a say, which we're practicing with case studies and debates.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could talk with [Name] about a local issue and how people can have a say in it.

Discussion and presenting

- **STRENGTH** [Name] shares ideas confidently in class discussions and listens well to others.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] presents their work clearly and answers questions about it.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] joins in with class discussions and is building confidence sharing ideas.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] presents their work and is learning to speak to a group with confidence.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is sharing ideas in class discussions and building on what others say, which we're practicing with talk partners and sentence starters.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could ask [Name] at dinner what they think about something from our topic, and why.

Extended writing

- **STRENGTH** [Name] writes well-structured answers that make a clear argument backed by evidence.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] writes clear, organized extended answers using key terms and evidence.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] writes extended answers and is learning to structure an argument.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] makes good points and is learning to back each one with evidence.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is structuring longer answers: a point, evidence and an explanation, which we're practicing with paragraph frames and model answers.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could ask [Name] to talk through the plan for a longer answer before writing it.

Science and social studies phrases to avoid, rewritten

Instead of	Write
Leo is careless in practicals.	Leo sometimes skips steps in a practical method. Our next step is following each step carefully, using a method card, and he is getting more accurate each week.
Mia is bad at science.	Mia is still building confidence in science and finds explaining results tricky. Sentence starters such as "I found that... because..." are helping.
Sam has no interest in history.	Sam is quieter in history discussions. He chose the Romans for his research task and is enjoying it, so we're building on that.
Ava can't read a map.	Ava uses simple maps and is learning compass directions and keys. Planning a short trip on a map app together at home would help.
Omar is not a science person.	Omar is at his best in hands-on lessons. Our next step is writing down what he found, so his results are as clear on paper as they are when he explains them.
Grace seems bored in social studies.	Grace is quieter in whole-class discussions but shares thoughtful ideas with a partner. We're working on bringing those ideas to the whole class.
Kai was unsafe with the equipment.	Leave the incident for a conversation with the family. In the report: "Kai's next step is following each step of a practical method carefully, with a method card."
Ethan copied his project from a website.	Don't write it. Talk to the family and follow your school's policy. The report can name the skill: "Ethan's next step is putting research into his own words and noting where information came from."
Priya writes strong CER paragraphs.	Priya writes clear conclusions that use data as evidence and explain the science behind them.
Noah can identify the independent and dependent variables.	Noah plans fair tests, changing one thing and measuring the effect while keeping everything else the same.
Zoe has strong substantive and disciplinary knowledge.	Zoe knows a lot about the periods we have studied and uses sources carefully to work out what really happened.
Ben shares his political views a lot in debates.	Ben joins debates with confidence. His next step is backing each point with evidence and responding to other views respectfully.
Lily is a budding scientist.	Lily asks thoughtful questions and suggested testing the paper towels with the same amount of water each time, which made our test fair.
Jack knows more dates than most of the class.	Jack has a secure sense of chronology and places events on a timeline confidently.
Isla always forgets her homework.	Isla handed in three of the last six research tasks. We go through a weekly checklist on Mondays, and a regular homework time at home would help.
Ruby is behind in science.	Ruby is still learning the key ideas from our forces topic. She has extra practice in a small group on Thursdays, and short quizzes are helping her remember them.
Finn should know his continents by now.	Finn knows four of the seven continents and is learning the rest. Finding them on a globe or map app at home would help them stick.
Eli's ADHD makes practicals hard for him.	Don't write it. Talk to the family in person. The report can say what helps: "Eli does his best practical work with a step-by-step method card and a clear job in his group."
Maya loves geography, just like her dad.	Leave family comparisons out. "Maya asks great questions about places around the world and finds them quickly on a map."
Theo hates writing up experiments.	Theo explains results well out loud. Our next step is writing a method clear enough for someone else to follow, using a writing frame.
Ada learned a lot about [topic] this term.	Ada can explain how the Romans changed Britain, including roads, towns and language.
Leo needs to focus, needs to listen and needs to finish his work.	Leo's next step is finishing each task, which we're helping with a short checklist and a check-in halfway through.

334 lines. Free from polytheseus.com/teacher-skills/guides/report-card-comments-for-science-and-social-studies, where a free builder puts them together and checks the wording. Drafted with AI help: read every line against what you know of the student and your school's report rules before you use it.